

Two fragments of bas-reliefs from the Kanaganahalli stupa. (Above, left) Gods and human kings worship the Buddha in aniconic form, represented by an empty throne and a pair of footprints. (Above, right) The Buddha's shorn hair, with turban, is brought before the gods to worship.

Regrettably, it seemed to both local and foreign scholars that for some years after the initial excavation some elements within the ASI appeared to be doing little to conserve the site and its incomparable statuary. Thankfully, that is certainly no longer the case and a full report entitled *Excavations at Kanaganahalli* has been published (if still very hard to obtain).

The smaller archaeological site of Phanigiri, or 'serpent-hill', is on a hilltop some 50 miles due east of Hyderabad in what is now Telangana State. Here there is a happier story to tell. It was first seriously excavated in 2001 by an ASI team led by the distinguished archaeologist Dr B. Subrahmanyam, the leading authority on the Buddhist archaeology in Andhra Pradesh, and excavations continue to this day, revealing an extensive site that had been plundered in the past but still retained a number of its carved bas-reliefs, statuary, pillars and gateway architraves, all much damaged but of exceptional quality.[11] As yet no portraits of rulers have emerged but several inscriptions bear the names of Satavahana rulers as well as those of the